SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

THE INFLUENCE OF RELIGIOUS EDUCATION ON THE CLASSROOM BEHAVIOR OF THE ELEMENTARY PUPILS

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Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

Background of the Study

Religious education plays a crucial role in shaping the moral and ethical behavior of elementary pupils. It goes beyond being just a subject for Filipino pupils, as it instills values such as respect, duty, and order. These values enable learners to interact positively with others and function effectively within their communities. Paul et al. (2025) found that Christian education at the Loakan Baptist Church Christian Education Center reduced negative behavior by promoting religious understanding, acceptance, and values formation. Moreover, Chansa (2023), in a study on the impact of religious education on pupils' behavior in selected secondary schools in Lusaka District, Zambia, attested that religious education prepares learners to become morally upright and influences them to fear God and respect fellow human beings. The findings further revealed that the teaching of religious education is a critical component that enables school-going youth to acquire morality by instilling proper attitudes toward social obligations and responsibilities in society. These studies suggest that teaching learners about religion alongside their schoolwork contributes to improved behavior and moral development both in school and in personal life.

Studies from various countries show that religious education positively contributes to pupils' behavior and moral development. In Romania, Coman et al. (2024), in their study titled "How Religion Shapes the Behavior of Students: A Comparative

Analysis Between Romanian Confessional and Non-Confessional Schools," found that pupils enrolled in religious schools and those who actively practiced their faith were less likely to display aggressive or delinquent behavior and were more inclined to collaborate and show care for others. Similarly, Han and Carlo (2021) reported that religious education strengthens adolescents' self-discipline and moral decision-making, lowering their tendency to engage in harmful or risky behaviors. In the Philippine context, elementary pupils who receive continuous religious instruction also tend to demonstrate more respectful, cooperative, and caring interactions with their classmates. Supporting this, Kadafi et al. (2021) found that religious and spiritually based virtual media significantly increased pupils' helpfulness, with prosocial behavior scores in the experimental groups rising by an average of 11.79 points.

These findings suggest that religious education not only teaches moral principles but also supports pupils' religious and moral formation, shaping both belief and daily behavior. This perspective aligns with Pope John Paul II's emphasis that religious formation must remain faithful to the Church's mission while adapting to modern realities an approach that helps pupils internalize values and express them through positive conduct (Sanchez, 2025).

Religious education teaches learners how to get along with others, work together, and respect teachers and other adults, which helps decrease behavior problems (Purnama et al., 2022). However, challenges remain in the consistent implementation of the curriculum and in maintaining pupil engagement (Ogula, 2024). Despite exposure to

religious education, some pupils continue to struggle to fully grasp moral values, which affects their behavior and social interactions. This situation highlights the need for family and community involvement in religious education and stronger collaboration between schools and homes (Kurniawan et al., 2022). Additionally, Teixeira et al. (2022) noted that teachers' attitudes and instructional strategies, such as storytelling and group discussions, help young learners understand moral values more effectively. Research also indicates that positive school environments shaped by religiosity are associated with reduced bullying and improved pupil–teacher relationships, thereby enhancing the benefits of religious education (Hannam et al., 2020).

Thus, religious education contributes to reducing youth misconduct and fostering a culture of respect and kindness (Smith, 2023). Ogula (2024) and Rochmat et al. (2024) reported that teachers often observe improvements in pupils' behavior, positive attitudes, and sense of responsibility both at school and at home as a result of religious education. These findings further emphasize the importance of aligning school-based religious education with the support of families and communities (Kurniawan et al., 2022). Pupils at Saint Michael College of Caraga in Nasipit exhibit behavioral concerns that indicate the need to strengthen Religious Education as part of the elementary curriculum. Based on interviews with teachers, challenges have been observed in delivering Religious Education, particularly in helping pupils connect lessons to their daily lives and in keeping pupils from different religious backgrounds fully engaged.

Teachers also reported that although non-Catholic pupils participate in Religious Education activities, some experience feelings of disconnection because the lessons primarily follow Catholic teachings. These observations highlight the need to examine how effectively the components of religious education, faith understanding, participation in worship and sacraments, and Christian morals influence pupils' daily classroom behavior regardless of religious affiliation. While numerous studies have emphasized the importance of religious education in teaching morals, character, and proper conduct, limited research has examined how specific components of religious education affect classroom behavior at Saint Michael College of Caraga. Addressing this gap is essential to the school's mission of producing graduates who are both responsible citizens and people of faith. It is also important for curriculum development, character formation, and the improvement of classroom behavior.

The goal of this study is to determine the influence of religious education on the behavior of elementary pupils at the Saint Michael College of Caraga Triangulo Campus. The findings of the study are expected to benefit the SMCC academic community in several ways. Teachers of Religious Education may use the results to enhance instructional practices and help pupils develop stronger moral and spiritual behavior through classroom activities. School administrators may design programs and activities that reinforce Religious Education learning and support teachers in creating a faith-centered learning environment. Parents may reinforce lessons learned in school at home and guide pupils in applying Christian values in daily life. Pupils may become more

disciplined, respectful, and compassionate as they connect Religious Education lessons with their behavior and daily actions. The SMCC academic community as a whole may promote a culture of faith, morality, and respect through strengthened collaboration among teachers, parents, and pupils.

Review of Related Literature

This chapter examines key books and research papers relevant to the present study, “The Influence of Religious Education on the Classroom Behavior of the Elementary Pupils.” The researcher reviewed related literature, online studies, and other academic sources to clarify the concepts, findings, and gaps that support this investigation. Each part of the literature is discussed to show how religious education, as an academic subject, may influence the classroom behavior of elementary pupils.

The study is anchored on the Catechism of the Catholic Church (CCC), which upholds three key factors that shape moral and spiritual formation: Faith and Understanding, Responsibility and Participation, and Respect for the Human Person and Good and Evil Acts. These factors guide the present research in identifying how religious education influences pupils’ behavior in the classroom.

Classroom behavior strongly influences pupils’ school performance. Dulay (2020) examined how pupils’ interactions with peers, participation in activities, and communication with teachers and other adults in authority affect their academic success. Dulay (2020) emphasized that cooperative behavior, respect, and active participation

contribute to a positive and supportive classroom environment. In contrast, disrespectful, off-task, or argumentative behavior toward teachers or classmates can hinder learning and slow academic progress. Dulay's (2020) work highlights the importance of understanding the link between classroom behavior and learning outcomes, since teachers can develop more effective strategies to improve behavior and promote success.

Similarly, pupils' actions in class affect both academic performance and personal growth. Dimacangun and Sambo et al. (2024) stated that pupils' behavior toward peers, classroom activities, educators, and authority figures significantly impacts academic achievement. Their research at Abaga Integrated School in the Philippines found that pupils who behaved well during class were more likely to succeed academically. However, they also noted that behavior toward peers, educators, and authority figures did not always significantly predict academic performance. Adulay (2020) supported this by showing that mixed classroom behaviors such as inattentiveness and talking over peers reduced engagement, though not consistently academic results. These findings suggest that responsible behavior and active participation in classroom activities are stronger indicators of academic success than mere compliance or social interaction, highlighting the need for teachers and administrators to understand behavioral influences in order to promote positive conduct and improve performance (Mafie et al., 2024).

Educators today recognize that teaching academics alone is not enough to develop responsible and moral pupils. Religious education, as part of holistic schooling, nurtures pupils' values, conscience, and character alongside academics. Many schools are

facing worsening behavior and declining morals, making religious education an important avenue for guiding pupils toward self-discipline, respect, and positive classroom conduct. Granero-Gallegos et al. (2020) argued that this situation calls for renewed attention to teaching religion in schools. Law-Davis (2023) likewise stated that religious education helps learners become respectful, empathetic, and self-controlled, improving social interactions and moral decision-making.

Research in different regions has also established that religious education influences pupils' moral behavior. In several European countries, including Ireland and Germany, religious education is integrated into school systems (Hyland & Bocking, 2020). This reinforces the view that religious education is not only about faith knowledge but also about forming responsible and ethical pupils. Thus, this review examines how religious instruction shapes children's ability to manage emotions, interact positively with others, and make moral choices. It also explains how religious values become part of pupils' daily classroom conduct, promoting habits such as respect for authority, care for others, and responsibility. Understanding these dynamics is important for creating learning environments that support both pupils' academic success and their development into morally responsible individuals.

By understanding how religious education influences classroom behavior, educators can design learning plans that help pupils grow academically and morally. Teachers can nurture well-rounded pupils by integrating moral and ethical principles into instruction. Such understanding also informs teacher training and strengthens values-

based education, enabling pupils to apply religious lessons to real-life situations and improving their social and personal development (Smith, 2023).

Religious Education

Religious education refers to religious cultivation or growth within a particular faith tradition, and also to education about religions that provides accurate information taught with sensitivity and understanding of religious language Priala, n.d. (2024). Moreover, Eric & Mbiti, (2024) stated that religious education helps pupils understand life in a multi-faith community by building awareness and respect for others' beliefs. In addition, Eric & Mbiti, (2024) added that religious education carries the responsibility of passing on knowledge, values, and attitudes that society needs to prosper.

In a broader sense, education, in general, is a strategic factor for national development, and it should empower pupils with skills, values, and critical thinking. Likewise, schooling shapes pupils' minds, relationships, and emotions, preparing them to contribute positively to their communities. Furthermore, Rochmat et al. (2024) emphasized that education encourages community involvement and prepares pupils to become responsible and helpful members of society. Within this context, within religious education, pupils learn beliefs and practices in ways that relate to their present lives.

Similarly, Hannam et al., (2020) argued that religious education should go beyond teaching rituals and doctrines by encouraging reflection, personal connection, and

application to daily experiences. Likewise, Jalal, (2022) noted that learning core religious values helps pupils understand right and wrong, develop empathy, and grow in responsibility values that influence how they behave toward others in the classroom.

Additionally, teaching methods are also important in religious education. Accordingly, Milerski, (2023) explained that effective teaching strategies help pupils grasp, apply, and internalize religious knowledge. For instance, common strategies include lectures, discussions, case studies, simulations, and applying religious values to everyday life (Orchard et al., 2024). However, ineffective methods may limit pupils' understanding and ability to apply religious concepts, negatively affecting both learning and moral practice (Khairani & Aloysius, 2023).

From a developmental perspective, Mathes (2019) offered an evolutionary perspective on Kohlberg's moral development theory, suggesting that understanding moral growth stages helps structure religious education to support moral reasoning. As pupils develop, as children mature, they understand abstract religious ideas better, and religious education supports this growth. Nevertheless, without emotional and practical support from families, religious concepts may remain theoretical.

To sustain this formation, for religious culture to grow, schools must agree on shared values, assign teachers to model these values, and collaborate with parents and communities. Consequently, a spiritually rich school environment helps pupils apply faith beliefs in both school and daily life. Supporting this view, Pupils Baha' (Students Baha'

Shawaqfeh & Almahaireh, n.d.) noted that positive psychology in learning promotes motivation, confidence, and creativity, while also strengthening teacher-pupil relationships and supporting mental well-being.

In other faith traditions, faith-based education in other traditions shows similar outcomes. For example, Bahri (2025) reported that Islamic religious education shapes pupils' morals and prevents moral decline by teaching honesty, respect, and responsibility. Furthermore, (Ramang, 2022)added that schools reinforce religious education through co-curricular activities such as prayer groups, retreats, and community service, helping pupils practice values and grow spiritually and morally.

Equally important, teacher competence affects the success of religious education. Specifically, (Law-Davis, 2023)found that teachers' confidence in Catholic primary RE improves when they have strong religious backgrounds and structured training, including Scripture pedagogy. Similarly, Abramowitz and Hellberg (2020) likewise argued that pupils grounded in Christian morals show greater self-control, perseverance, integrity, humility, and accountability. As a result, such values help pupils stay focused in school, cooperate with others, and manage peer pressure. Ultimately, this spiritual-moral foundation supports academic and personal well-being (Rifa Hidayah, 2021). In addition, Anugrah et al., (2025) showed that PBL deepens pupils' understanding of religious teachings and encourages practical moral reflection.

Faith, Understanding, and Doctrine

According to the CCC, faith is both a gift from God and a human response rooted in understanding and trust (CCC 158). Thus, faith seeks understanding, meaning that believers should know, reflect on, and deepen revealed truths. In elementary religious education, therefore, this connection supports pupils in integrating doctrine into daily life.

Importantly, early exposure to religious values greatly influences pupils' character formation. In support of this, Masdul (2024) emphasized that introducing faith-based teachings at a young age shapes positive attitudes and behaviors that last over time. Through this process, through guidance from teachers and structured religious lessons, pupils begin to develop a sense of right and wrong that helps regulate their actions in daily school life. Consequently, the consistent guidance provided by teachers allows pupils to internalize moral lessons instead of simply memorizing religious concepts.

Moreover, connecting doctrine to real-life experiences strengthens pupils' understanding of their faith. In line with this, Zafar Iqbal and Irsa Zahoor, (2024) found that linking religious teachings to everyday situations helps pupils develop stronger moral awareness and practical wisdom. As a result, when pupils see the relevance of faith in their own lives, they become more likely to show honesty, kindness, and compassion in their behavior. Therefore, this connection allows religious instruction to move beyond theory and become a guide for daily decision-making.

Furthermore, according to Manea, (2019) noted that continuous religious instruction enables pupils to connect belief with action, making moral behavior a natural

part of their daily routine. Through repetition, through repeated exposure to religious principles, pupils learn to practice patience, understanding, and empathy toward others. Consequently, this consistent formation strengthens self-discipline and helps pupils manage their behavior in academic and social settings. Supporting this, Marks & Dollahite, (2025)further concluded that religious participation supports moral, social-emotional, and academic development, reinforcing prosocial classroom behavior.

Participation in Worship and Sacraments

According to Church teaching, the CCC teaches that participation in worship and the sacraments is central to Christian life because it unites believers with Christ and strengthens them through grace (CCC 1066–1075). In particular, sacraments such as Baptism, Eucharist, and Reconciliation nourish spiritual growth, build community, and shape moral behavior. For this reason, for pupils in Catholic schools, liturgical participation fosters responsibility, reverence, and belonging.

Additionally, religious education also strengthens pupils' responsibility and participation within school life. Empirical evidence shows that Arif & Elya, (2021) found that value-based religious character education increased pupils' school and community participation and improved responsible behavior in group tasks. Similarly, Rachmadtullah et al., (2024) observed similar growth in accountability and engagement when religious character education was implemented systematically. Likewise, Hidayat (2024) explained that consistent religious character education strengthens pupils' sense of responsibility

and involvement in moral activities. Moreover, Jusubaidi et al. (2025) added that transformative religious education links moral lessons to real-life experiences, teaching pupils that responsibility means acting with honesty, compassion, respect, cooperation, and empathy.

Furthermore, Rodríguez-Fernández,(2025) showed that spiritual pedagogy in religious education encourages deep conversation, reflection, and ethical decision-making among pupils. In the same way, Kurniawan et al., (2022) also noted that RE routines help pupils express spiritual understanding and apply religious values daily. Within Catholic education, Catholic curriculum integrates faith and reason through sensory worship and sacramental life (Franchi & Davis,2024), forming whole-person development. Accordingly, Monte Cassino, n.d. (2025) described sacraments as visible signs of God's love that reinforce discipline, respect, and empathy. In practice, in elementary RE, sacraments are taught as foundational experiences that strengthen Catholic identity (Archdiocese of New York, 2021) and encourage participation in prayer, service, and moral living(Franchi & Davis, 2021).

As a result, participation in religious activities strengthens discipline and responsibility through lived experiences. Specifically, Paul et al., (2025) explained that group prayer, reading of sacred texts, and involvement in religious social activities offer pupils practical opportunities to apply moral teachings. Consequently, these experiences help transform theoretical learning into real-life behavior by developing habits of empathy, self-control, and service. Over time, continuous involvement builds a

supportive environment where good behavior is encouraged through shared responsibility and community values.

Christian Morals and Respect for Others

Fundamentally, the CCC teaches that every human person has dignity because they are created in God's image; therefore, moral formation requires respect, justice, and compassion. Accordingly, pupils must learn to distinguish good and evil acts and choose what is right.

Consistent with this teaching, religious education promotes respect for others among elementary pupils. For instance, Sari and Nugroho (2022) found that pupils exposed to value-based religious education showed stronger respect toward classmates, teachers, and school staff, including peaceful conflict resolution and helpfulness. Likewise, Lestari et al. (2021) reported that religious moral education improved pupils' ethical awareness, leading to kinder peer relationships and cooperative classroom behavior Similarly, Kleindienst & Kleindienst, (2024) supported this, emphasizing that religious and moral education fosters awareness of human dignity, empathy, and ethical conduct.

Beyond the classroom, religious education extends beyond classroom learning by helping pupils apply values daily. In support of this, Priala, (2024) highlighted that education fosters tolerance and moral awareness in changing societies. Additionally, Arif & Elya, (2021)found that schools integrating faith-based practices (prayers, projects, moral reflection) strengthened discipline and collaboration. Similarly, Liu (2024) reported

that structured religious teachings increased pupils' good acts such as honesty, rule-following, and helping classmates. Moreover, AfifaKhanam et al., (2021) found that pupils who regularly participated in religious learning developed greater empathy and accountability. As a result, increased sensitivity to others' feelings improved decision-making and social behavior. Consequently, moral awareness supported peaceful interaction and fairness in daily school life. Overall, positive behavior was strengthened through the consistent practice of religious values.

Further evidence shows that Niskaromah, Abdullah A. C., and Amalia P. (2025) observed improved honesty, helpfulness, and discipline among pupils who participated in structured religious lessons. In turn, understanding the importance of good acts made pupils more capable of resisting negative influences. As a result, responsible behavior increased as learners practiced moral principles in real-life situations. Consequently, respect for others became more visible in classroom and community interactions.

Similarly, Debbarma (2024) likewise showed that pupils exposed to moral teachings were less likely to engage in lying, cheating, and bullying. Thus, strong moral guidance supported better self-regulation and behavioral control. Moreover, awareness of the consequences of harmful actions strengthened ethical decision-making. Ultimately, trust, harmony, and respectful relationships were reinforced through continuous moral education. Ogula, (2024) emphasized that valuing approaches moral debates, reflection, and real-life application help pupils internalize virtue and behave ethically.

Behavior

Religious Education directly improves observable classroom behavior among elementary pupils by reducing disruptions and fostering respect. Franklin et al. (2024) noted that misbehaviors such as talking out of turn, ignoring directions, and showing disrespect lower engagement and strain teacher–pupil relationships. Through activities like prayer, storytelling, and moral reflection, Religious Education teaches attentiveness, self-control, and discipline, which are seen in pupils listening carefully, following routines, and completing tasks responsibly. EdD Dissertations & Bell (2024) emphasized early intervention in misbehavior, and Religious Education provides this by instilling values that guide pupils to resolve conflicts peacefully and cooperate with peers. Hakim et al. (2020) highlighted the importance of values education, and Religious Education makes this concrete through measurable actions such as helping classmates, volunteering for tasks, and refraining from bullying. As Mastroianni & Gilbert (2023) observed, global moral challenges persist, making Religious Education essential in shaping pupils' daily interactions into respectful, disciplined, and compassionate conduct that supports learning.

Moreover, research also links religion and behavior to academic outcomes. Horwitz, (2021)found that pupils with stronger religious commitment tended to show higher levels of school engagement and more positive learning attitudes. Consequently, better classroom participation and respect for school rules were observed among these pupils. In addition, strong value systems were linked to improved behavioral choices.

Furthermore, increased motivation and focus contributed to more stable classroom conduct. However, Abimbade et al. (2019) reported mixed findings, showing religion did not significantly predict attitudes toward misconduct among some Nigerian pupils. Taken together, these varied results support the need for the present study in the Philippine elementary context.

Similarly, Dimacangun & Sambo, (2024)reiterated that classroom behavior affects performance, with activity-related behavior being the strongest predictor. In line with this, O. Ramacula & C. Pañares (2023)added that behaviorism explains how classroom environments shape pupil conduct, meaning teachers can directly improve behavior through guided reinforcement. Additionally, Temel et al., (2024) found that participation in traditional children's games improved pupils' sense of belonging and positive social behavior, contributing to better school awareness and sportsmanship. Likewise, Marks & Dollahite, (2025) observed that disruptive behavior frequently stems from lack of rule-following and poor listening skills, stressing the importance of strong teacher-pupil relationships, clear classroom routines, and structured expectations.Panaligan (2019) found that character education helps pupils understand the importance of respecting others, and that pupils often imitate teachers who model respectful and ethical behavior. Overall, institutional policies, school climate, extracurricular activities, and clear behavioral standards contribute significantly to shaping pupils' conduct in school environments.

Child protection policies and classroom management practices can be meaningfully connected to the role of Religious Education in shaping pupils' behavior. Castino (2023) emphasized that anti-bullying campaigns are most effective when schools distinguish between playful actions and harmful conduct, reinforcing positive behavior through praise and rewards. This approach resonates with the values taught in Religious Education, which highlight respect for human dignity, compassion, and fairness. When pupils internalize these values, they are more likely to treat classmates kindly and resolve conflicts peacefully, making child protection policies more effective. Similarly, Jayme and Tantiado (2025) found that clear rules, consistent procedures, and structured instruction improve learner behavior, which aligns with the discipline and responsibility fostered in Religious Education through participation in worship, sacraments, and moral reflection.

Furthermore, Dulay (2020) highlighted that positive peer interactions strengthen cooperation and create supportive learning environments, whereas negative peer relationships often lead to disruptive behavior and reduced academic performance. In this context, religious education has been found to positively shape peer interactions by promoting empathy, respect, and acceptance. Adili et al. (2023) reported that 58.5% of teachers observed improved attitudes among pupils toward peers of different religions, races, and backgrounds. Specifically, religious teachings emphasizing forgiveness, humility, kindness, and cooperation were found to reduce interpersonal conflict and improve classroom harmony. Additionally, Nur Hayati (2020) further revealed that school cultures that integrate spiritual routines such as prayer and value-based activities

strengthen pupils' patience, empathy, and respect for peers, transforming moral awareness into habitual prosocial behavior.

Learners' Classroom Behavior Toward Classmates/Schoolmates

According to Dulay, (2020) says that how elementary school pupils interact with their classmates significantly affects how they behave in class, including how well they do in school and with other kids. In particular, positive relationships with peers are often linked to greater teamwork, while negative interactions can lead to disruptive behavior and make it harder to do well in school.

Similarly, Adili et al., (2023) reported that many teachers observed RE improving pupils' attitudes toward peers of various faiths and backgrounds by strengthening empathy, tolerance, and respect. This was evident in diverse classroom contexts.

Likewise, Nur Hayati (2020)examined the integration of religious character education within school culture and its impact on pupils' moral behavior and social relationships. The findings revealed that when spiritual principles are consistently practiced through daily routines such as morning reflections, prayer, and value-based cooperative activities, pupils gradually develop empathy, patience, and respect toward peers. As a result, these behaviors contribute to a cooperative classroom environment where learners support one another and resolve conflicts peacefully. Overall, the findings emphasized that faith-based school culture does not merely teach moral values but

actively shapes pupils' interaction patterns, transforming moral awareness into habitual prosocial behavior that strengthens classroom harmony and peer relationships.

In elementary settings, elementary learning environments consist of young learners who are still adjusting to structured settings that differ significantly from their home environments. According to studies, According to Aseery, (2024)learners often encounter challenges related to following schedules, adapting to classroom routines, and interacting with unfamiliar peers and teachers. Consequently, these adjustment processes directly influence classroom behavior toward classmates and schoolmates, particularly in the development of cooperation, communication, and social participation. In comparison, successful adjustment is associated with respectful, friendly, and cooperative behavior, while difficulties in adaptation may manifest as withdrawal, conflicts, or disruptive actions. Thus, understanding these behavioral patterns is essential in evaluating pupils' social development and their overall adjustment to formal school settings.

Moreover, According to B. Jayme & C. Tantiado, (2025), most pupils prefer maintaining classroom peace by avoiding unnecessary conflicts and practicing polite and cooperative behavior toward their peers. As a result, these behaviors contribute to a safe, supportive, and inclusive learning environment where pupils feel encouraged to participate and express themselves. In this process, teachers play a critical role in fostering these behaviors by integrating conflict resolution skills and social-emotional learning (SEL) into daily classroom instruction. Through this approach, through SEL, pupils

develop empathy, self-regulation, and effective communication skills, which enable them to manage emotions and resolve disagreements in constructive ways. Consequently, the consistent teaching of these competencies strengthens peer cooperation, mutual respect, and shared understanding within the classroom community.

Furthermore, Jayme a Iqbal, Zafar and Zahoor, Irsa (2024) stated that classroom behavior problems such as excessive talking, rudeness toward classmates, disruptive actions, and violent behavior significantly interfere with teaching and learning processes. As a consequence, these behaviors disrupt instructional flow, distract other learners, and reduce overall classroom engagement. Additionally, they also contribute to feelings of fear, tension, and discomfort among pupils, creating hostile learning environments where respect and cooperation decline. Over time, persistent behavioral problems negatively affect academic performance as well as pupils' social and emotional development. Therefore, the study emphasized the importance of maintaining consistent classroom discipline and implementing effective behavior management strategies, including clear rules and social-emotional learning, to ensure a safe and productive learning environment.

Likewise, According to Madalo et al., (2025)teachers experience considerable challenges due to poor classroom management and persistent pupil misbehavior during learning sessions. As a result, these challenges hinder effective instruction, disrupt classroom organization, and slow pupils' academic progress. In response, teachers have adopted visually stimulating learning materials, interactive teaching strategies, and

learner-centered approaches to restore classroom order and enhance engagement. Similarly, Alakashee et al. (2022) emphasized the importance of addressing behavioral problems at the elementary level. Specifically, the study explained that unaddressed behavior issues significantly hinder pupils' ability to acquire essential academic and life skills needed for long-term success. Consequently, persistent behavioral problems were linked to reduced classroom participation, missed learning opportunities, and declining interest in learning. As a result, pupils struggled to develop critical academic competencies such as problem-solving, critical thinking, and effective communication. Therefore, Alakashee et al. (2022) further stressed that early intervention is crucial because it supports the development of both academic and social-emotional skills required for successful schooling and future professional life.

Learners' Classroom Behavior Toward School Activities

According to Dulay, Lolita (2020) says that how a pupil feels about school activities strongly affects how much they participate in learning, which, in turn, affects how well they do in school. In this way, active participation in projects and classroom work improves learning, but a lack of interest or disruptive behavior may result in lower grades.

In support of this, Estrada et al. (2019) found that pupils receiving religious education show stronger self-discipline and healthier responses to challenges, becoming more motivated and consistent in schoolwork. Likewise, religious values such as duty, honesty, and service encourage pupils to view schooschool tasks as meaningful. Similarly,

Hafid and Guru Sekolah Dasar (2019) reported that consistent reinforcement of discipline, cooperation, and responsibility results in increased learner participation and sustained effort. As a result, pupils exposed to character-focused teaching tend to exert more effort during school activities and demonstrate stronger collaboration skills. Overall, these behaviors reflect a shift from compliance-driven participation to internally motivated engagement, which strengthens both academic and social learning outcomes.

Furthermore, learners' conduct during school activities directly affects the classroom atmosphere and the effectiveness of instruction. Accordingly, Ramacula and Pañares (2023) noted that learners who display attentiveness, respect, and cooperation allow teachers to manage time more efficiently and implement interactive strategies with fewer disruptions. Similarly, Herman et al. (2018) emphasized that appropriate classroom behavior reduces interruptions and enhances emotional regulation among learners. Thus, this interaction between behavior and instruction highlights how positive conduct functions as a structural support for meaningful learning experiences.

In addition, participation in school-wide and co-curricular activities reinforces behavioral patterns associated with teamwork, discipline, and social responsibility. For example, Temel et al. (2024) observed that learners involved in traditional games and school engagement programs develop higher levels of sportsmanship, rule adherence, and collaborative skills. Consequently, these experiences strengthen learners' emotional attachment to the school environment, which in turn encourages consistent positive behavior during both classroom and extracurricular activities.

Ultimately, sustained positive behavior toward school activities is associated with long-term academic and personal development. Specifically, Dimacangun and Sambo (2024) emphasized that learners who consistently engage in structured activities and demonstrate self-regulation are more likely to develop persistence and independent learning habits. Moreover, the presence of supportive classroom management practices and values-oriented instruction strengthens these outcomes by guiding learners toward responsible participation and adaptive learning behaviors.

Learners' Classroom Behavior Toward Teachers and Persons in Authority

Based on existing research, Based on Dulay, Lolita (2020) Research has shown that the relationships between elementary school pupils and their teachers and other adults in charge have a big impact on how well they do in school. In particular, pupils who get along well with their teachers are more likely to follow the rules and participate, while bad behavior can ruin the learning environment and hurt academic performance.

In this regard, religious education significantly influences how elementary learners perceive and interact with teachers and other figures of authority by cultivating attitudes of respect, obedience, and positive interpersonal relationships within the school setting. For instance, Vega Sya'bana et al. (2024) identified acts of disrespect, including disobedience and rude behavior, as among the most serious forms of pupil misconduct, underscoring the importance of fostering mutual respect between learners and educators. Furthermore, learners' behavior toward teachers and administrators is further

shaped by their exposure to biblical teachings that emphasize obedience, recognition of leadership, and adherence to authority. Supporting this, the Fordham Institute reported that pupils in Catholic schools exhibit stronger self-control, greater respect for property, improved openness to others' viewpoints, and enhanced ability to resist negative peer pressure, indicating that faith-based education contributes to higher levels of discipline and respect for authority structures.

Likewise, Sarkadi (2022) examined how integrating character education into religious learning processes strengthens pupils' respect, compliance, and moral responsibility toward authority figures. The findings revealed that when educators intentionally incorporate value-based instruction focusing on honesty, humility, and self-discipline, pupils demonstrate increased reverence and willingness to follow classroom rules. In addition, continuous moral formation was also shown to improve pupils' internal self-regulation, reduce tendencies toward defiance, and promote positive perceptions of authority. Through this process, through sustained exposure to value-oriented instruction, moral principles move beyond theoretical understanding and become evident in pupils' actual classroom behavior and discipline, demonstrating the transformative effect of faith-based pedagogy on respectful conduct.

Moreover, religious education further teaches learners that respect for authority is rooted in spiritual accountability, reinforcing the belief that obedience to legitimate authority reflects obedience to divine order. As a result, this perspective reduces tendencies toward argumentation, defiance, and disruptive behavior among pupils.

Accordingly, emphasizing Christian virtues such as humility, obedience, and submission to rightful authority strengthens teacher pupil relationships and contributes to a more orderly, focused, and productive classroom environment. Over time, as learners internalize these faith-based values, they develop stronger self-discipline and greater respect for institutional structures, creating a foundation for responsible behavior within formal learning environments.

Temel et al. (2024) argued that religious values serve as a central foundation for moral and character development by guiding individuals' thoughts, actions, and social interactions. Acting as such, acting as an internal moral compass, these values support ethical decision-making grounded in spiritual duty and social responsibility. When applied in schools, when religious education is integrated into formal schooling, it extends beyond mere instruction and becomes a transformative process that shapes pupils' attitudes and dispositions. Through consistent practice, through consistent engagement in prayer, reflection, and the study of sacred texts, learners acquire virtues such as honesty, compassion, humility, and respect, which gradually become embedded in their daily behavior. Ultimately, these virtues not only promote harmonious relationships within school communities but also strengthen pupils' spiritual growth and alignment with both divine guidance and societal expectations.

Theoretical Framework

This study is guided by Bandura's Social Learning Theory (1986) and Kohlberg and Power's Theory of Moral Development (1981). Bandura (1986) explains that pupils learn

behaviors and values through observation, imitation, and interaction. This theory is relevant to Christian religious education because pupils acquire moral behavior by watching teachers, peers, and religious figures. It highlights the school's role in shaping classroom behavior through modeling and reinforcement.

Bandura's theory includes four related processes: observational learning, modeling, cognitive processes, and self-regulation. Observational learning occurs when pupils watch moral and faith-based behavior in school. Modeling happens when teachers demonstrate classroom conduct aligned with Christian values. Cognitive processes involve pupils interpreting and internalizing what they observe. Self-regulation refers to pupils controlling their actions based on learned Christian principles. Together, these processes explain how religious education can influence classroom behavior by shaping what pupils believe and how they act.

Kohlberg and Power's (1981) Moral Development Theory complements Bandura by explaining stages of moral reasoning, from avoiding punishment to making principled ethical choices. Religious education supports pupils in moving through these stages by providing moral discussions, Bible stories, prayer, and sacramental participation. These experiences allow pupils to reflect on right and wrong and practice faith-based moral decisions. As pupils mature morally through these stages, they become more responsible, kind, forgiving, and respectful in classroom life.

In summary, Bandura (1986) explains how pupils learn behavior through modeling and self-regulation, while Kohlberg and Power (1981) explain how pupils develop moral

reasoning through stages. Both theories support the study's focus on how religious education influences elementary pupils' classroom behavior, particularly through faith understanding, responsible participation, and respect for others.

Schematic Diagram

Independent Variables **Dependent Variables**

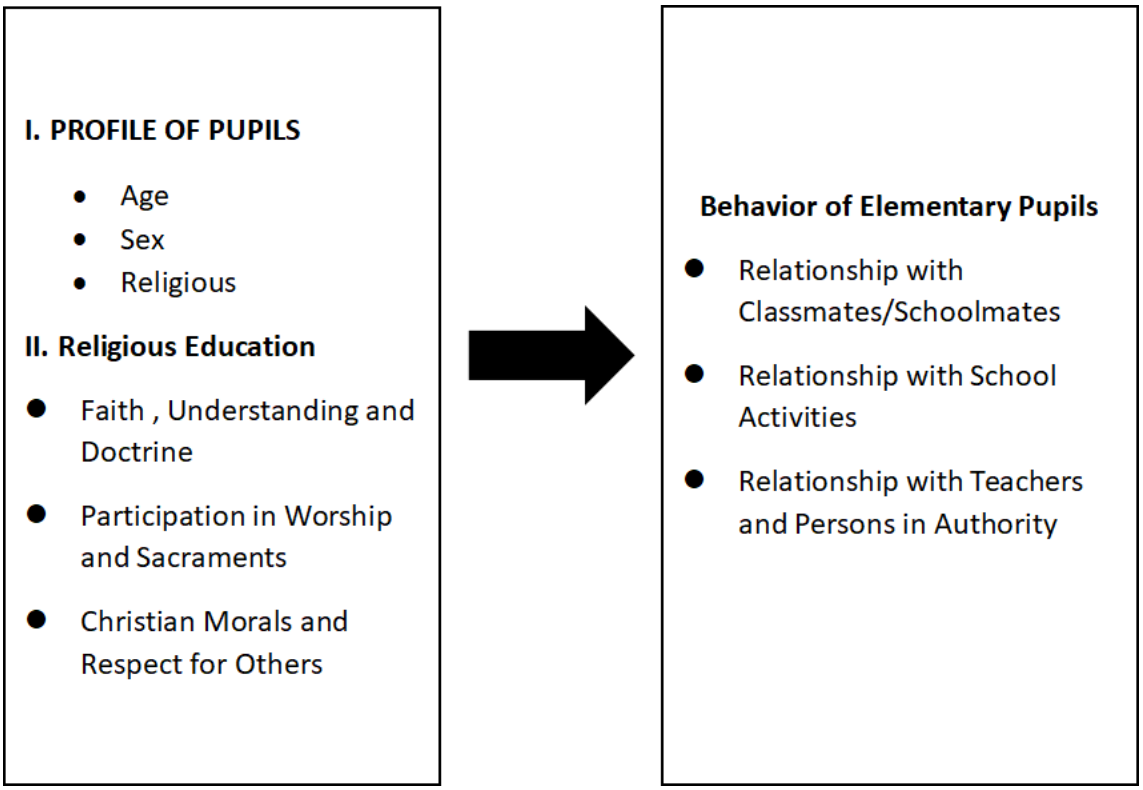


Figure 1. The schematic diagram displays the interplay of the variables of the study

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine the influence of religious education on the behavior of elementary pupils at Saint Michael College of Caraga, Triangulo Campus, during the School Year 2025–2026. Specifically, it will answer the following questions:

1.What is the profile of pupils in terms of:

1.1 age;

1.2 Sex, and

1.3 Religion?

2. What is the level of implementation effectiveness of religious education as subject in the Elementary Catholic School of:

2.1 Faith, understanding and doctrine;

2.2Participation in Worship and Sacraments;

2.3 Christian morals and respect for others; and

3. To what extent is the Influence of ReEd to respondents behavior:

3.1 Their relationship with the classmates/schoolmates;

3.2 Their engagement in school activities; and

3.3 Their relationship with teachers and persons in authority?

4. Is there a significant relationship between pupils' Religious Education and their classroom behavior?

5. Is there a significant difference in pupils' Religious Education level and behavior when grouped according to age, sex, and religion?

Hypothesis of the Study

As the study investigates the relationship between religious education practices and pupils' behavior, the following hypotheses are proposed:

Null Hypothesis

To determine the relationships and differences examined in this study, the following null hypotheses will be formulated and tested at a 0.05 level of significance.

HO_1: There is no significant relationship between pupils' Religious Education and their classroom behavior.

HO_2: There is no significant difference in the behavior of pupils when grouped according to their profile such as age, sex, and religion.

Scope and Limitation

This study will examine how religious education influences the behavior of elementary pupils at Saint Michael College of Caraga, Triangulo Campus, during the School Year 2025–2026. Specifically, it will focus on how the three key factors of religious education, Faith, Understanding and Doctrine, Participation in Worship and Sacraments, Christian Morals and Respect for Others, affect pupils' classroom behavior. The research will investigate how these aspects of religious formation shape pupils' relationships with their classmates and schoolmates, participation in school activities, and interactions with teachers and persons in authority.

The scope of the study will be limited to pupils from Grades 3 to 6, as these grade levels are considered crucial for moral and behavioral development. The research will focus solely on the experiences of pupils at the Saint Michael College of Caraga, Triangulo Campus. Factors beyond the school setting, such as family background, peer influence outside of school, and socioeconomic status, will not be included in the analysis. Additionally, the study will not cover the long-term effects of religious education beyond the elementary level or compare findings with other schools.

Definition of Terms

To ensure clarity in this study, it is important to define key terms and concept operationally. This is to facilitate understanding of the terminology and context of the study on The Influence of Religious Education on the Behavior of Elementary Pupils:

Age refers to the number of years since birth of the respondents enrolled at Saint Michael College of Caraga, as reflected in school records

Behavior refers to the observable actions and responses of the respondents within the classroom setting of Saint Michael College of Caraga, including interaction with classmates, participation in school activities, and behavior toward teachers and persons in authority, as indicated in their questionnaire responses.

Behavior Toward Classmates or Schoolmates refers to how respondents at Saint Michael College of Caraga interact with their peers during classroom and school.

Faith, Understanding, and Doctrine refers to the level of knowledge and understanding of religious teachings among respondents of Saint Michael College of Caraga.

Christian Morals and Respect for Others refers to the extent to which respondents at Saint Michael College of Caraga demonstrate behaviors consistent with Christian values, such as honesty, respect, obedience, kindness, and cooperation.

Religion refers to the religious affiliation of the respondents enrolled at Saint Michael College of Caraga, as indicated in school records or survey responses.

Religious Education refers to the faith-based subject implemented at Saint Michael College of Caraga, as reflected in the respondents' level of Faith, Understanding, and Doctrine, Christian Morals and Respect for others, and Participation in worship and sacraments.

Participation in Worship and Sacraments refers to the extent of involvement of respondents at Saint Michael College of Caraga in school-organized religious practices, including attendance in Mass, participation in prayer activities, involvement in religious events, and reception of sacraments.

Sex refers to the biological classification of the respondents enrolled at Saint Michael College of Caraga as male or female, based on school enrollment records.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter presents the research design, research locale, research respondents, research instruments, ethical standards, data-gathering procedure, and data analysis plan and procedure.

Research Design

The study will use both a descriptive-correlational and descriptive-comparative design. The descriptive component will focus on presenting the level of Religious Education received by elementary pupils and the manner in which they behave in school. The correlational component will investigate whether a significant relationship exists between Religious Education and pupils' classroom behavior.

The overall aim of the study is to describe the current situation and determine the extent to which pupils' behavior is influenced by the Religious Education they receive. Through this approach, reliable data will be gathered to address the research questions and provide valuable insights for teachers, parents, and school administrators in enhancing instructional practices, classroom management, and values formation.

Research Environment, Population and Sample

The study will take place at Saint Michael College of Caraga, Triangulo is a Catholic educational institution located at Atupan Street, Barangay 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, with approximate geographical coordinates of 8.9698° N latitude and 125.3389° E longitude. Established in 1948, the institution has consistently provided quality education

anchored in Christian values, academic excellence, and social responsibility. The main campus serves as the administrative and academic hub, catering to various levels of education from basic to higher learning.

To accommodate the increasing number of learners, Saint Michael College of Caraga expanded its facilities through the establishment of the Triangulo Campus, which houses the Basic Education Department, particularly the Elementary level. Saint Michael College of Caraga is a Diocesan Catholic school that offers educational programs from pre-school to tertiary education. The Elementary Department was formally established in June 2005. The campus provides a structured and nurturing environment designed to support pupils' holistic development spiritually, intellectually, and socially.

This educational setting is characterized by a supportive school community, competent educators, and adequate learning resources. Such an environment allows the effective implementation of diverse teaching approaches and strategies that foster active engagement and improved learning outcomes among elementary respondents.

Research Respondents

The study will involve pupils enrolled in Grades 3-6 at Saint Michael College of Caraga, Triangulo Campus, during the 2025–2026 school year. Purposive sampling will be employed to ensure equal representation across grade levels. Grades 3 to 6 will be selected because respondents at this developmental stage will be particularly influenced by religious education in their behavior within and outside the classroom.

Table 1. The Distribution of Respondents of the Study

	Male		Female		Total	
Grades	F	%	F	%	F	%
Grade 3	2	7.14	3	10.34	5	8.77%
Grade 4	10	35.71	3	10.34	13	22.81%
Grade 5	9	32.19	13	44.82	22	36.60%
Grade 6	7	25	10	34.48	17	29.82%
Total	28		29		57	100%

The study's respondents comprised 57 elementary respondents from Grades 3 to 6 at the Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC), Triangulo Campus, selected through purposive sampling due to their developmental susceptibility to religious influence. As detailed in Table 1, the sample is nearly evenly divided by sex, consisting of 28 males and 29 females. The distribution across grade levels shows that Grade 5 represents the largest group with 22 pupils (38.60%), followed by Grade 6 with 17 pupils (29.82%), Grade 4 with 13 pupils (22.81%), and Grade 3 with 5 pupils (8.77%). Within these groups, males are most numerous in Grade 4 (10 students), while females have their highest representation in Grade 5 (13 students). These participants, enrolled for the 2025–2026 school year,

provide a demographic cross-section used to analyze how profile variables like age, sex, and religion relate to classroom behavior and religious engagement.

Research Instruments

Content validation will be conducted to ensure the instrument's validity. Experts in education and research will review the questionnaire to assess whether the items will accurately measure the intended variables, and their feedback will be used to refine the instrument. A pilot test will then be administered to a small group of respondentswho will not be included in the main sample.

The questionnaire for the Religious Education variable is a researcher-made instrument developed by the researcher based on related literature. It focuses on four key factors: Faith, Understanding and Doctrine, Participation in Worship and Sacraments, Christian Morals and Respect for Others, affect pupils' classroom behavior. These factors are anchored in the Catechism of the Catholic Church (CCC) to ensure that the instrument aligns with Catholic teachings on faith, morals, and values. This part of the instrument will undergo content validation by experts in education and theology to ensure each item accurately measures the intended concept. A pilot test will also be conducted in Jesu Elementary School to determine its reliability using Cronbach's alpha

For the Behavior variable, the study will use a standardized instrument adapted from Dulay (2020) in her study "Classroom Behavior and Academic Performance of Public Elementary School Pupils." This tool measures pupils' behavior in three domains: (1) relationship with classmates or schoolmates, (2) relationship with school activities, and

(3) relationship with teachers and persons in authority. Permission to adapt this instrument will be obtained, and its reliability will be re-assessed before the main data collection.

2.4 Data Gathering Procedure

The researchers will follow a systematic procedure to ensure that data collection is accurate, reliable, and ethically conducted. First, the researchers will ask permission from the Dean to conduct the study. Once approved, the researchers will proceed to request permission from the School Principal of Saint Michael College of Caraga, Triangulo Campus. After receiving the Principal's approval, the researchers will seek the assistance of the classroom advisers in distributing and retrieving the questionnaires among all 57 pupil respondents from Grades 3 to 6.

Before administering the questionnaires, the researchers will clearly explain the purpose and procedures of the study to the respondents. They will also inform them about the possible risks and benefits of the study. The study has minimal risks, such as slight discomfort or shyness when answering some questions. The benefits include improving the Religious Education program, helping teachers better guide the respondents, and supporting the development of positive classroom behavior. It will be emphasized that participation is voluntary and that all responses will be treated with strict confidentiality. Parents or guardians will also be requested to sign a consent form to allow their children to participate in the study, ensuring compliance with ethical standards involving minors. Only respondents with signed and approved parent/guardian consent

will be included as official respondents in the data analysis. Respondents without consent forms will automatically be excluded from the study to ensure ethical compliance and proper selection of participants.

The primary research instrument will be a structured questionnaire composed of two validated tools: a self made questionnaire of Religious Education Practices Instrument and a standardized Behavior Instrument (adapted from Dulay, 2020). The questionnaires will be administered during regular class hours with the assistance of classroom advisers, who will ensure that the pupils clearly understand each item.

Data Analysis Plan and Procedure

The collected data will be organized, analyzed, and interpreted using appropriate statistical methods suited for a quantitative descriptive–correlational design. Frequency and Percentage. To describe the profile of the respondents in terms of age, sex, and religion.

Mean. This will be used to determine the level of religious education practices and the behavioral manifestations of elementary pupils.

Pearson Correlation Coefficient (r). This will be used to determine whether there will be a significant relationship between religious education practices and the behavior of elementary respondents when grouped according to their profile variables.

Comparative Analysis. This will be used to determine whether respondents with higher engagement in religious education will demonstrate better classroom behavior across all behavioral areas compared to those with lower engagement.

The results will be interpreted using a Four-point Likert scale and analyzed both descriptively and inferentially to answer the research questions and achieve the study's objectives.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

The study respects intellectual property rights by ensuring that all research outputs, including instruments and analytical frameworks used, will be protected under Philippine copyright law. All third-party sources and secondary data used in this research will be properly cited. Since no new logos, symbols, or brands will be created, there will be no need for trademark registration.

B. Informed Consent

The research team will clearly explain the study's purpose, procedures, risks, and benefits to all participants. Before data collection, the elementary school respondents who will participate will be informed that participation is voluntary and that their responses will remain confidential. The researcher will provide a permission letter to the parents or guardians, who will then give their written consent for the child's participation. This process ensures compliance with ethical standards for research involving minors and guarantees that respondents are fully informed of their rights and the study details before taking part.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

A structured questionnaire will be used to collect personal and sensitive data for this study. Researchers will keep all responses confidential. To protect privacy, participants' data will be anonymized by assigning unique identifiers instead of names or other identifying information. All files will be stored digitally and protected by passwords, accessible only to authorized members of the research team. Anonymized data may be shared with third parties, such as school administrators or research colleagues, only for academic purposes and with prior consent from participants or their guardians. This process will ensure compliance with data privacy laws and ethical standards.

D. Voluntary Participation

The study will only use human as respondents and not involved animals as respondents .Respondents in the study will be informed that they can withdraw at any time without facing any negative consequences. During the informed consent process, this right will be clearly explained to both participants and their guardians, ensuring voluntary participation without coercion or academic repercussions.

E. Minimization of Harm

Respondents in this study are expected to experience minimal risk. To minimize any potential physical, psychological, or emotional harm, all questionnaire items will be carefully designed to avoid sensitive or distressing topics. Participants were informed of their right to discontinue participation if they felt uncomfortable at any point during the data collection process. Appropriate support services to such as referral to guidance center for counseling services and school clinic for health services will be provided if

needed. These measures ensure that all participants are treated ethically and that their well-being remains the top priority throughout the research process.

F. Beneficence

This study will contribute to academic knowledge by showing how religious education influences the behavior of elementary pupils, which may improve teaching methods and lesson design. It aims to help teachers and pupils develop better approaches to encourage positive behavior through faith-based instruction. The results will also promote moral and ethical growth among young learners, fostering responsible and compassionate individuals. Research findings will be made available to participants and their guardians upon request to ensure transparency.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Respondents will be selected through purposive sampling, focusing on Grades 3 to 6 pupils at Saint Michael College of Caraga, Triangulo Campus, who are at a key stage of moral and behavioral development. This method will ensure fairness by selecting participants based on clear academic and developmental criteria relevant to the study's objectives. All qualified pupils within this grade range will have an equal opportunity to participate, ensuring just and unbiased representation.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Researchers will ensure data integrity and accuracy by following standardized procedures in data collection and analysis. A validated structured questionnaire with a

four-point Likert scale will be used to measure religious education practices and pupil behavior. Data will be carefully encoded, checked for consistency, and analyzed using appropriate statistical tools to maintain reliability and accuracy. All findings will be recorded truthfully and interpreted objectively to uphold the study's credibility.

I.Transparency in Reporting

The research results will be reported honestly and transparently. Findings will be presented accurately and will not be manipulated or selectively reported. All references, copyrighted materials, and other relevant sources will be properly cited and acknowledged in accordance with citation standards. Any patented materials used will be clearly identified and credited to their rightful owners, ensuring the protection of intellectual property rights.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

The researchers will utilize a researcher-made questionnaire and conduct a pilot test to ensure its validity and reliability. The second instrument, which will be used for the other variable, will be adapted from a reputable online source. Proper acknowledgment will be given to the original author and source. All materials will be used ethically and in full compliance with copyright laws to ensure respect for intellectual property rights.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

The study ensures that participants may withdraw at any time without consequences, and support will be provided to any pupil who feels uncomfortable or needs help during the data-gathering process.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

The researchers utilized AI tools, specifically ChatGPT and Grammarly, to support the development and refinement of the research manuscript. ChatGPT was employed to assist in organizing ideas, enhancing clarity, and generating academically appropriate phrasing, while ensuring that all content remained consistent with the study's objectives. Grammarly was used to verify grammar, spelling, and coherence, thereby maintaining the overall quality and readability of the document. These AI tools were used solely as aids in the writing process, with all research decisions, analyses, and interpretations conducted independently by the researchers

.**M. Ethical Approval**

Ethical approval for the study will be obtained from the Institutional Research Rthics Committee(REC) of Saint Michael College of Caraga, ensuring full compliance with ethical guidelines on participant protection, data privacy, and intellectual property rights.

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APPENDICES

CURRICULUM VITAE



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Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

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EMAIL: ianclark adams@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Male
Date of birth : September 9,2004
Height : 5'5
Weight : 53
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Beunavista SPED High School 2020-2021
Secondary : Beunavista SPED High School 2020-2021
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: PRINCESS LEE A. BAYLON
ADDRESS: Purok-4 Manapa Buenavista Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: princesslee_Baylon@smcc.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Female
Date of birth : June,7,2005
Height :5'1
Weight : 33
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Manapa 1 Elementary School 2015-2016
Secondary : Saint. James High School 2020-2021
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: JOHN JEFFRY A. DE GUZMAN
ADDRESS: Purok 3 -Brgy 9 Buenavista Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: johnjeffrey_deguzman@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Male
Date of birth : April 18 ,2005
Height : 5'6
Weight : 65
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Beunavista Central Elementary School 2015-2016
Secondary : Beunavista Central Elementary School 2015-2016
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: JELIA P. PAINIT
ADDRESS: P-7, Sitio San Jose , Durian, Las Nieves, Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: Jelia_painit@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Female
Date of birth : October 21,2005
Height : 5'0
Weight : 55
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : San Jose Elementary School 2015-2016
Secondary : Durian National High School 2020-2021
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: CHONA V. REDUCTO
ADDRESS: Purok-7 Mabini, Afga Sibagat Agusan del Sur
EMAIL: chona_reducto@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Female
Date of birth : November 13,2004
Height :
Weight :
Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Afga Central Elementary School 2015-2016
Secondary : Afga National high school 2020-2021
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

APPENDICES

A. **Letter of Approval**
B. **Instrument and Informed Consent**
C. **Map of the Research Locale**
D. **Narrative & Photo Documentation**
E. **Certificate of Technology Based Assessment**

A.Letter of Approval

Saint Michael College of Caraga
C. Atupan Sr. St., Brgy. 4 Poblacion, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte
Tel. No.: 085-300-2932
facebook.com/smcccollegeofteachereducation

COLLEGE OF TEACHER EDUCATION

October 29, 2025

BERNA JESSA M. GANZAN
School Principal
Saint Michael College of Caraga
Brgy. Triangulo, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte

Dear Mrs. Ganzan

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Elementary Education (BEED) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we third-year students group 3, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitle: **"The Influence of Religious Education on the Behavior of Elementary Pupils"**

With your expertise and kind consideration, we are humbly requesting your permission to conduct our research study among grade 3 - 6 pupils in the elementary department. Your approval and support in this academic endeavor will greatly contribute to the successful completion of our study.

We look forward for your favorable response to this request. Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

KIM ANGELIE M. LEPORNIO
Group Leader

Noted by:
10/29/25
RHEAN L. SANCHEZ
Research Adviser

Received and Approved by:
BERNA JESSA M. GANZAN
OIC - Elementary Principal

Informed Consent

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
Atupan St., Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte 8602, Philippines
Website: www.smccnasipit.edu.ph ; Tel. Nos. 085 300-2932

environments have been clearly defined, ensuring that participants understand how their information will be utilized and protected in an online context.			☐ Not Applicable	

RECOMMENDED ACTION:

- ☐ APPROVED
- ☐ MINOR MODIFICATIONS MUST BE IMPLEMENTED
- ☐ MAJOR MODIFICATIONS MUST BE IMPLEMENTED
- ☐ DISAPPROVED

RECOMMENDATION GIVEN BY:

Click here to enter text.
Ethics Committee Representative

DATE SIGNED: Click here to enter text.

SMCC-REC FORM 4
RESEARCHER'S INFORMED CONSENT TO PARTICIPANTS

Instructions:
1. For research that are not under SMCC, you may attach your consent form and skip this part.
2. For SMCC researchers fill out the forms truthfully. Make sure to declare the necessary risks as stipulated in your ethics declaration.

TITLE OF THE STUDY Click here to enter the text	
NAME/S OF THE RESEARCHER/S: Kim Angelie M. Lepornio Ian Clark Adams Princess Lee A. Baylon John Jeffrey A. De Guzman Jelia P. Painit Chona V. Reducto.	
DEPARTMENT: College of Teacher Education	**COURSE:** Bachelor in Elementary Education
INTRODUCTION You are being invited to participate in a research study conducted by researcher/researchers above who are affiliated with Saint Michael College of Caraga.	

Members:

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
Atupan St., Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte 8602, Philippines
Website: www.smccnasipit.edu.ph ; Tel. Nos. 085 300-2932

You have been selected as a potential informant because you meet the criteria necessary for inclusion in our study. Your participation in this study is entirely voluntary. We encourage you to take your time to review the information provided below. Please feel free to ask any questions or seek clarification on any part of the study that you do not fully understand before deciding whether to participate. Additionally, you may choose to discuss your potential involvement in this research with family members or friends. Should you decide to participate, you will be asked to sign this consent form. A copy of this form will be provided for your records.	
In case of concerns about the study, you may contact the Research And Instructional Innovation Deparment through the following: • Email: riid@smccnasipit.edu.ph • Contact number: 09778064574 Or the researchers of this study: • EMAIL: Kimangelie_lepornio@smccnasipit.edu.ph • CONTACT NUMBER: 09563817386	
PURPOSE OF THE STUDY	This study aims to accomplished the following: This study aims to determine the influence of religious education on the behavior of elementary pupils at Saint Michael College of Caraga, Triangulo Campus. It seeks to assess how practices such as attending Mass, communication, instruction, participation in religious activities, and reception of sacraments affect pupils' behavior toward classmates, school activities, and teachers or persons in authority. The findings will help enhance the integration of moral and spiritual values in classroom instruction, guide teachers in promoting positive behavior, and support the school's goal of developing both academically competent and morally upright learners.
PROCEDURES OF THE STUDY	Please Check below which type of study is being conducted ☑For Quantitative and Survey Questionnaires: *If you volunteer to participate in this study, you will be asked to participate by answering the survey questionnaire which you can finish in less than 30 minutes.* ☐ For Interviews/ FGD / Case Studies *If you volunteer to participate in this study, you will be asked to participate by answering the questions in the interview guide which may last 30-40 minutes depending on the length of the interview. Moreover, this will be recorded through audio or video.*

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	☐ For capstones and experimental studies *If you volunteer to participate in this study, you will be asked to participate by allowing the researchers to use specimens and other data needed related to the research.*

POTENTIAL RISKS AND DISCOMFORTS

You may experience some discomfort during the interview/questionnaires due to the sensitive nature of the topics being discussed. If at any point you encounter questions that cause psychological or emotional distress, you have the right to decline to answer without any consequence. Additionally, you may choose to withdraw from the study at any time if you feel unable to continue discussing the requested information. The researchers prioritize your well-being and will ensure that your comfort and welfare remain their highest priority throughout the study.

Potential discomforts are:

1.Slight nervousness when taking tests.
2.Mild stress during classroom participantion.

POTENTIAL BENEFITS TO PARTICIPANTS AND/OR TO SOCIETY

This study aims to generate valuable insights that may benefit both public and private sector administrators, as well as human resource managers and policy-makers. The findings and discussions derived from this research can provide evidence-based information that may inform decision-making processes and strategic planning. Additionally, the results of this study may be of particular interest to government agencies such as:

1. The study can help pupils and teachers improve moral values, behavior, and classroom interactions through strengthened religious education practices.
2. It may guide government agencies like DepEd and CHED in creating programs that promote moral and spiritual formation among elementary learners.

CONFIDENTIALITY

All information gathered in this study will be treated with the utmost confidentiality, in accordance with applicable laws and regulations. Any identifiable information collected will be kept strictly confidential, except in cases where disclosure is necessary to protect your rights or welfare. This confidentiality agreement ensures that the researchers can protect your participation information from being accessed by individuals who are not directly involved in the study. When the results of this research are published or presented at conferences, your identity will not be revealed, and no personally identifiable information will be used.

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Website: www.smccnasipit.edu.ph ; Tel. Nos. 085 300-2932

PARTICIPATION AND WITHDRAWAL

Your participation in this study is entirely voluntary. Choosing not to participate will not result in any penalty or loss of benefits to which you are otherwise entitled. By participating in this study, you are not waiving any legal claims, rights, or remedies. You may withdraw from the study at any time without any negative consequences.

RESEARCH PARTICIPANT'S CONSENT

I have read and understood the information provided above. I have had the opportunity to ask questions, and my questions have been answered to my satisfaction. I understand that I will receive a copy of this consent form. I am aware that I can withdraw my consent at any time and discontinue my participation in the study without any penalties or loss of benefits to which I am otherwise entitled.

t.

Name And Signature Of The Partcipant

Date Signed:

IF ILLITERATE

I have witnessed the accurate reading of the consent form to the potential participant, and the individual has had the opportunity to ask questions. I confirm that the individual has given consent freely.

Name And Signature Of The Partcipant

Thumb Print

RESEARCHER'S CERTIFICATION

I have explained the details of the research study to the participant, answered all questions posed, and ensured that the participant fully understands the information provided in this document. I believe that the participant has freely given their consent to participate in the study.

NAME AND SIGNATURE OF THE PARTCIPANT
Date Signed: Click here to enter text.
Confirmation of Participant/s
Click here to enter text.
NAME AND SIGNATURE OF THE PARTCIPANT

B.Instrument and Informed Consent

Saint Michael College of Caraga

Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines

District 8, Brgy. Triangulo, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines

Tel. Nos. +63 085 343-3251 / +63 085 283-3113

www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

Respondent Profile Survey

(Optional) Name: _____

Address: _____

Part I: Pupil's Profile

Panudlo: Palihug itsek ang angay nga item nga nagtugma sa imong tubag:

(**Direction:** Please check the appropriate item that corresponds to your answer:)

Edad (Age)

( ) 9 ka tuig (9 years old)

( ) 10 ka tuig (10 years old)

( ) 11 ka tuig (11 years old)

( ) 12 ka tuig (12 years old)

1. Seks (Sex)

( ) Lalaki (Male) ( ) Babaye (Female)

Religious Education Practices in School

Panudlo: Irate kung unsa ka kanunay nimo nabati nga kaning mga binuhatan naa sa inyong eskwelahan.Ibutang ang check mark (√) sa husto nga kolum nga imong pilion.

(**Directions:** Rate the extent to which you feel these practices are present in your school. Put a check mark (√) on the appropriate column of your choice. Be guided by the indicators below:)

Scale **(Skala)**	**Description** **(Deskripsyon)**	**Interpretation** **(Kahubanan)**
4	Strongly Agree (Kusgan nga Uyon)	It happens every single time without fail. (Mahitabo kini pirme ug walay palya.)
3	Agree (Uyon)	It happens frequently, but not all the time (Kanunay kini mahitabo, pero dili pirmi.)
2	Disagree (Dili Uyon)	It happens occasionally (Usahay ra kini mahitabo.)
1	Strongly disagree (Kusgan nga Dili Uyon)	It does not happen at all (Dili kini mahitabo bisan gamay.)

Religious Education	Kusgan nga Uyon (Strongly Agree) (4)	Uyon (Agree) (3)	Dili Uyon (Disagree) (2)	Kusgan nga Dili Uyon (Strongly Disagree) (1)
A. Faith and understanding and Doctrine				
1. I listen to lessons about God. (Naminaw ko sa mga leksyon bahin sa Ginoo.)				
2. I try to understand Bible teachings. (Mosulay ko pagsabot sa mga pagtudlo sa Bibliya.)				
3. I ask when I do not understand a lesson about faith. (Mangutana ko kung dili ko kasabot sa leksyon about sa pagtuo.)				
4. I remember what the teacher says about Jesus. (Hinumdoman ko ang gitudlo sa maestra o maestro about ni Jesus.)				
5. I read or look at Bible stories in class. (Mobasa or motan-aw ko og mga Bible stories sa klase.)				
6. I join reflections about God. (Moapil ko sa mga pagpamalandong about sa Ginoo.)				
7. I think about how God wants me to act.				

(Maghunahuna ko unsa ang gusto sa Ginoo nga akong buhaton.)				
8. I talk about Jesus with respect. (Mistorya ko about ni Jesus nga may respeto.)				
9. I learn the meaning of Christian words we study. (Makat-on ko sa kahulugan sa mga Kristohanong pulong nga among giestoryahan.)				
10. I thank God in prayer for guidance. (Magpasalamat ko sa Ginoo sa pag-ampo para sa iyang giya.)				
B. Participation in Worship and Sacraments				
1. I take part in religion class activities. (Muapil ko sa mga kalihokan sa religion class.)				
2. I finish my religion tasks on time. (Mahuman ko ang akong mga buluhaton sa religion on time.)				
3. I bring my materials for religion lessons. (Madala ko ang akong gamit para sa religion lessons.)				
4. I help classmates during religion work. (Mutabang ko sa akong mga classmates sa religion work.)				
5. I follow class instructions in faith lessons. (Motuman ko sa instructions sa klase sa faith lessons.)				

6. I volunteer in class prayer or reading when asked. (Movolunteer ko sa class prayer or pagbasa kung pangayuon.)				
7. I show effort in learning about God. (Magpakita ko og paningkamot sa pagkat-on about sa Ginoo.)				
8. I stay focused during faith tasks. (Magpabilin ko og focus sa faith tasks.)				
9. I take care of school things used in religion class. (Ampingan ko ang mga butang sa klase nga gigamit sa religion.)				
10. I join group activities to learn together. (Muapil ko sa group activities para makat-on uban sa uban.)				
C. Christian Morals and Respect for Others				
1. I am kind to others like Jesus teaches. (Mabuotan ko ug sama sa giingon nga pagtulon-an ni Jesus.)				
2. I speak politely to classmates and teachers. (Mahinayon ko og estorya ug magrespetar sa classmates ug teachers.)				
3. I listen when someone talks. (Maminaw ko kung naay nagstorya.)				
4. I forgive others when they make mistakes.				

(Mopasaylo ko sa uban kung masayop sila.)				
5. I avoid using hurtful words. (Dili ko mogamit og mga pulong nga makasakit.)				
6. I choose to do what is right because God wants me to. (Pili-on ko ang sakto kay mao ni ang gusto sa Ginoo.)				
7. I tell the truth in school and at home. (Magsulti ko og tinuod sa eskwela ug sa balay.)				
8. I avoid hurting others in my words and actions. (Likayan ko ang pagpasakit sa uban sa akong pulong ug binuhatan.)				
9. I say sorry when I do something wrong. (Mosulti ko og sorry kung nakasala ko.)				
10. I try to show love to others each day, following Jesus' example. (Maningkamot ko nga magpakita og gugma sa uban matag adlaw, nagsunod sa pananglitan ni Jesus.)				
D. Christian Prayer				
1. I pray to God in school. (Mag-ampo ko sa Ginoo sa eskwela.)				
2. I join the class prayer with respect. (Muapil ko sa class prayer nga may respeto.)				
3. I stay quiet during prayer time. (Maghilom ko during prayer time.)				

4. I listen to the prayer leader. (Maminaw ko sa prayer leader.)				
5. I pray for my family and classmates. (Mag-ampo ko para sa akong pamilya ug classmates.)				
6. I thank God in my prayers. (Magpasalamat ko sa Ginoo sa akong pag-ampo.)				
7. I ask God to guide my decisions. (Mangayo ko og giya sa Ginoo sa akong mga desisyon.)				
8. I join Bible sharing activities with respect. (Muapil ko sa Bible sharing nga may respeto.)				
9. I listen during Bible sharing sessions. (Maminaw ko during Bible sharing.)				
10. I reflect on the Bible message and apply it to my actions. (Mopamalandong ko sa mensahe sa Bibliya ug buhaton ko kini sa akong kinabuhi.)				

Learners' Classroom Behavior
(This is an adopted instrument from Dulay (2020) however, translations are provided by the researchers).

Panudlo: Irate kung unsa ka kanunay nimo nabati nga kaning mga binuhatan naa sa inyong eskwelahan.Ibutang ang check mark (√) sa husto nga kolum nga imong pilion.

(**Directions:** Rate the extent to which you feel these practices are present in your school. Put a check mark (√) on the appropriate column of your choice. Be guided by the indicators below:)

Scale **(Skala)**	**Description** **(Deskripsyon)**	**Interpretation** **(Kahubanan)**
4	Strongly Agree (Kusgan nga Uyon)	It happens every single time without fail. (Mahitabo kini pirme ug walay palya.)
3	Agree (Uyon)	It happens frequently, but not all the time (Kanunay kini mahitabo, pero dili pirmi.)
2	Disagree (Dili Uyon)	It happens occasionally (Usahay ra kini mahitabo.)
1	Strongly disagree (Kusgan nga Dili Uyon)	It does not happen at all (Dili kini mahitabo bisan gamay.)

Behavior Towards Classmates or Schoolmates	**Kusgan nga Uyon** **(Strongly Agree)** **(4)**	**Uyon** **(Agree)** **(3)**	**Dili Uyon** **(Disagree)** **(2)**	**Kusgan nga Dili Uyon** **(Strongly Disagree)** **(1)**
1. I demonstrate respectful behavior. (Nagpakita ko ug maayong batasan.)				

2. I ask apology whenever necessary. (Mangayo ko'g pasaylo kung kinahanglan.)				
3. I challenged other's mental and physical weaknesses. (Dili ko magdaot sa kusog o hunahuna sa uban.)				
4. I tease classmates, schoolmates and laugh at anybody's wrong answers. (Manungog ko og magkatawa sa sayop sa uban.)				
5. I enjoy fooling / kidding classmates anybody else in the school which cause troubles. (Malipay ko pag magbinuang nga makasamok sa mga tawo sa eskwelahan.)				
6. I initiate verbal/ physical fights. (Ako ang magsugod ug away.)				
7. I possess a good relationship with peers. (Maayo akong pakig-uban sa akong mga amigo.)				
8. I interrupt or intrude on others. (e.g, butts in into conversation or games) (Manghilabot ko sa uban samtang nagstorya o nagdula sila.)				
9. I keep hand, feet, objects and unkind remarks to myself.				

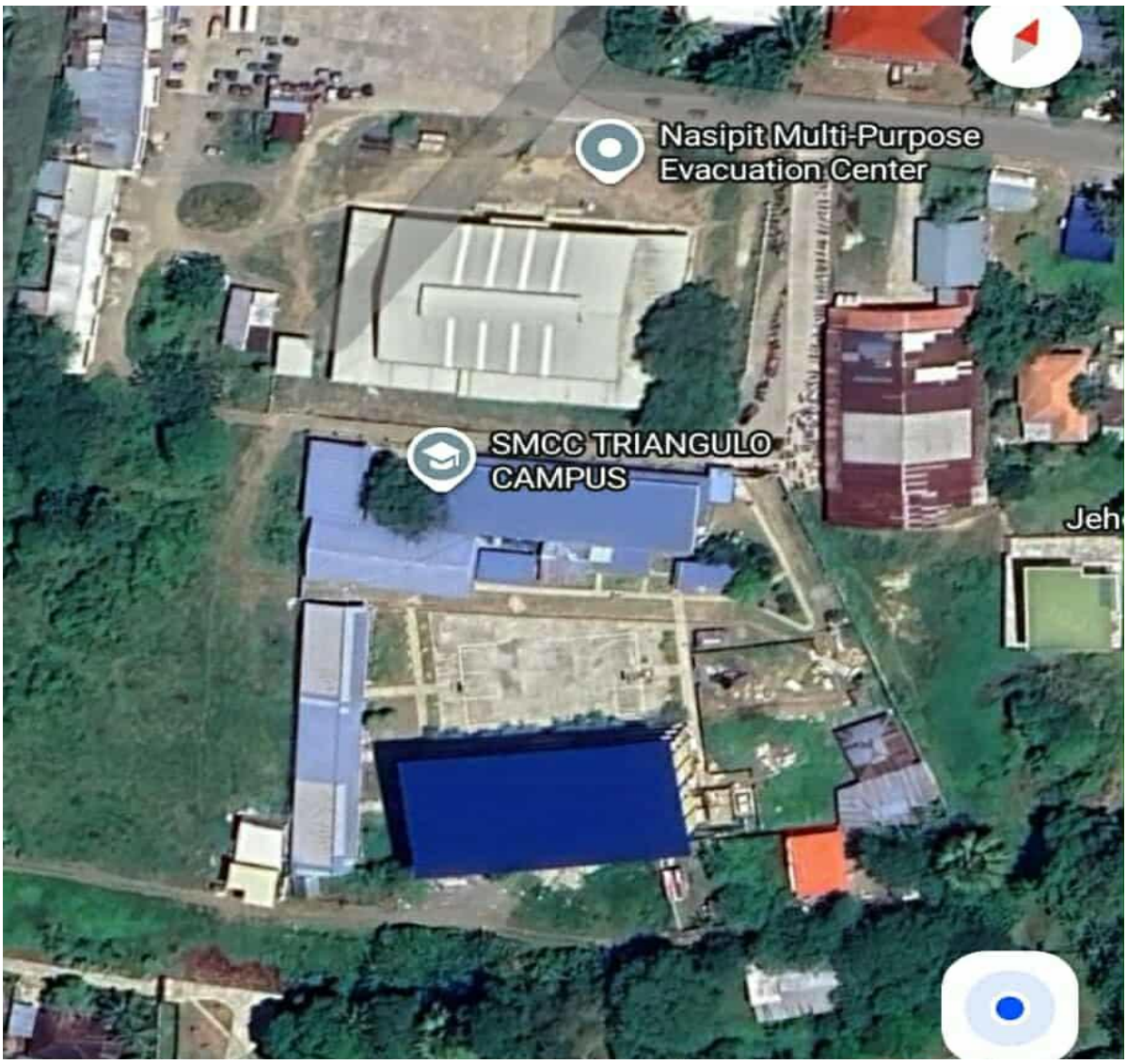
(Ginapugngan nako akong kamot, tiil ug daotang istorya..)				
Learners' Classroom Behavior Towards School Activities	**Kusgan nga Uyon (Strongly Agree) (4)**	**Uyon (Agree) (3)**	**Dili Uyon (Disagree) (2)**	**Kusgan nga Dili Uyon (Strongly Disagree) (1)**
1. I bring complete materials to be used for class activities at all times. (Magdala ko pirmi ug kumpletong gamit sa klase.)				
2. I recite with my others classmates (Hindi ako sumasali sa mga pangkatang aktibidad.)				
3. I don't participate in group activities (Dili ko mag-apil sa grupo o kalihokan.)				
4. I copy from the work of others (Mangopya ko sa trabaho sa uban.)				
5. I just play around not doing the projects (Magdula ra ko imbis magtrabaho.)				
6. I do not stand up to recite. (Dili ko manindog kung pa-recite-on.)				
7. I look around for the answer (Mangita ko ug tubag sa uban.)				
8. I Get angry to my teacher for calling me to recite. (Masuko ko sa guro kung tawgon ko mag-recite.)				

Learners' Classroom Behavior Towards Teachers and Persons in Authority	Kusgan nga Uyon (Strongly Agree) (4)	Uyon (Agree) (3)	Dili Uyon (Disagree) (2)	Kusgan nga Dili Uyon (Strongly Disagree) (1)
1. I leave the class with teacher's permission. (Mangayo ko ug permiso kung mo-gawas sa klase.)				
2. I exhibit politeness to the teachers and person of authority. (Magpakita ko ug respeto sa mga guro ug opisyal sa eskwelahan.)				
3. I follow classroom rules and teachers expectations. (Mosunod ko sa mga balaod sa klase ug sa gusto sa guro.)				
4. I listen quietly while teacher explains. (Maminaw ko sa guro kung magtudlo siya.)				
5. I listen when spoken to directly. (Maminaw ko kung ako ang ginaistoryahan.				
6. I commit habitual absences from the class. (Pirmi ko mag-absent.)				
7. I talk excessively (Magsige kog tabi bisag nagtudlo ang guro.)				
8. I actively defy or refuse to comply request or rules.				

(Dili ko mosunod sa sugo o balaod.)				
9. I report to class/school late. (Ma-late ko sa klase o sa eskwelahan.)				

B.Map of the Research Locale

Map of the Research Locale Coordinates



8.9698° N latitude and 125.3389° E longitude

C.Narrative & Photo Documentation

PREPARATION FOR INCOMING RESEARCH TITLE HEARING



DURING THE CONDUCT OF RESEARCH TITLE HEARING



AFTER THE CONDUCT OF RESEARCH TITLE HEARING



PREPARATION FOR THE TITLE PROPOSAL





ON THE DAY OF THE PROPOSAL



E. Certificate of Technology Based Assessment

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
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Website: www.smccnasipit.edu.ph ; Tel. Nos. 085 300-2932

TEST RESULT
TECHNOLOGY-BASED QUALITY ASSURANCE

Date of Test	October 27, 2025	**Control number**	**RBEED125003**	
Research Title	**The Influence of Religious Education on the Behavior of Elementary Pupils**			
Author (s)	1	Kim Angelie M. Lepornio	**ORCID No.**	0009-0002-7439-3997
	2	Ian Clark P. Adams	**ORCID No.**	0009-0000-8924-8579
	3	Princess Lee A. Baylon	**ORCID No.**	0009-0004-2083-6152
	4	John Jeffrey A. De Guzman	**ORCID No.**	0009-0002-6109-0372
	5	Jelia P. Painit	**ORCID No.**	0000-0001-5043-2205
	6	Chona V. Reducto	**ORCID No.**	0009-0000-5327-2550
Co-author (s)	1	Rhean L. Sanchez	**ORCID No.**	0009-0009-1699-2466

Contact Person	Kim Angelie M. Lepornio
Address	Purok 3 - Abilan Buenavista Agusan del Norte
Mobile Number	09563817386

Test subject	Chapters 1-2				
Total number of words	**11,252**	**Sentences**	**604**	**Characters**	**77,233**

	Test Area	Score	Required	Remarks
	(1) Plagiarism	98	90%	PASSED
	(2) Grammar	98	95%	PASSED
	(3) Readability Score	33	25	PASSED
	(4) AI Text Detection	37	40%	PASSED
	(5) Reliability *(Test Instrument only)*	N/A	N/A	

FINDING(S) & RECOMMENDATION(S)

Evaluated by:	Approved by:
MICHELLE ANN G. LUCINO Signature over Printed Name	**KENNETH IAN B. BARRERA, MA** Head of Research

Member:

Email: communications@smccnasipit.edu.ph